

Tech Stack Comparison: WeMakeSmall (Astro/Tina.io) vs. Webflow

This document outlines the strategic advantages of the **WeMakeSmall** technology stack (Astro, Tailwind CSS, Tina.io) compared to using a proprietary platform like **Webflow**.

Executive Summary

While **Webflow** is a powerful visual development tool, it is ultimately a "walled garden" that controls your code, hosting, and monthly costs.

The **WeMakeSmall Stack** provides the same high-end visual quality but with **100% code ownership**, superior mobile performance, and **limitless extensibility** at a fraction of the long-term cost.

1. Ownership: The Renter vs. The Owner

The most critical difference is who holds the keys to your digital property.

Feature	Webflow (The Renter)	WeMakeSmall (The Owner)
Code Ownership	Limited. You can export static code on expensive plans, but you cannot export the CMS or dynamic features.	100% Yours. You own every line of source code. It lives in a Git repository you control.
Hosting	Locked. You must host with Webflow if you use their CMS. If they raise prices, you pay.	Universal. Host anywhere (Vercel, Netlify, AWS). You have total freedom to move if you choose.
Portability	Difficult. Moving away means rebuilding logic and CMS structures from scratch.	Effortless. Your content and code are portable. Moving hosts takes minutes, not weeks.

The "Rent vs. Buy" Reality

- Webflow:** You are renting your website. If Webflow changes its terms or pricing, your business is beholden to them.
- WeMakeSmall:** You own your digital asset. It is a permanent piece of intellectual property for your business.

2. Performance & SEO: Speed Wins

Speed is the #1 factor for mobile conversions and Google rankings.

Webflow: The "Visual Builder" Tax

- Bloated Code:** Visual builders often generate excessive HTML/CSS to handle their drag-and-drop interfaces.

- **JavaScript Heavy:** Often relies on heavy JS libraries for simple interactions, slowing down page loads on 3G/4G networks.
- **Core Web Vitals:** Can be harder to optimise for perfect "100" scores due to platform constraints you cannot control.

WeMakeSmall (Astro): Built for Speed

- **Zero-JS by Default:** Astro ships only the HTML and CSS needed for the page. JavaScript is only loaded when strictly necessary (e.g., for a contact form).
- **Blazing Fast:** Designed specifically for content-rich sites to load instantly, boosting SEO rankings.
- **95+ Speed Guarantee:** It is much easier to achieve and maintain top-tier performance metrics because we control every line of code.

3. Cost & Scalability: The "Success Tax"

Webflow's pricing model punishes you for growing your business.

Webflow

- **Tiered Pricing:** You pay more as you grow. Plans have strict limits on CMS items (e.g., 2,000 items). Exceeding this requires an "Enterprise" plan (often A\$15k+/year).
- **Per-Seat Costs:** You pay extra for every editor or designer who needs access to the dashboard.
- **Bandwidth Limits:** High traffic spikes can push you into expensive tiers unexpectedly.

WeMakeSmall

- **Lean Scaling:** We deploy on enterprise platforms like Vercel or Netlify (often free or <A\$30/mo for massive traffic).
- **Unlimited Content:** Tina.io has no arbitrary limits on how many blog posts, projects, or pages you can have.
- **No Per-Seat Fees:** Add as many staff members to update content as you want without paying extra "license fees."

4. Customisation & Capabilities

Webflow

- **Visual Limits:** You can only build what their interface allows. Complex logic requires "hacking" custom code embeds.
- **Rigid CMS:** CMS fields are standardised. You can't easily create complex relationships or highly custom logic without third-party tools.
- **App Store Reliance:** "Apps" are often needed for basic features (like multi-language), adding monthly costs and dependency risks.

WeMakeSmall

- **Limitless Code:** Since it's built on standard web technologies (React/JavaScript), we can build literally anything—calculators, complex API integrations, or unique customer portals.
- **Tailwind CSS:** Allows for a completely bespoke design system that is maintainable and consistent, without fighting a visual editor's defaults.
- **Component Architecture:** We build reusable "LEGO blocks" (components) that ensure design consistency across thousands of pages.

5. Support: The Human Connection

Webflow

- **Ticket-Based:** Support is often limited to email tickets or community forums, with response times varying based on your plan tier.
- **No Code Help:** They generally support the platform interface, not your specific implementation or design choices.

WeMakeSmall

- **Direct Access:** There is a real person behind the technology. I am available to help with critical updates, answer questions, and provide guidance (within reason). You have a direct line to the expert who built your site, ensuring you are never left stranded.

Summary Recommendation

Webflow is best for:

- Designers who cannot code.
- Small marketing sites that don't need complex data handling.
- Quick prototypes where long-term ownership isn't a priority.

WeMakeSmall Stack (Astro) is best for:

- **Professional Growth:** Businesses that expect to scale beyond basic marketing pages.
- **Performance:** When SEO and load speed are critical competitive advantages.
- **Security & Ownership:** Organisations that demand control over their data and infrastructure.
- **Cost Efficiency:** Long-term value without ballooning monthly SaaS fees.

Choose the stack that builds an asset, not a liability.